

PlayIQ Module 1: The AI Learning Code

Your mission: learn how to control the genie

You have met Orion, captured your initial diagnostic signals, and configured your first AI workshop. Now you will learn the foundational skill that makes every other AI capability work: **choosing the exact kind of help you want before you ask for it.**

AI is not a magical crystal ball, and it is not a human brain. It is an amplifier. If you feed it a lazy, vague prompt like `"help me with this worksheet"`, it guesses what you need. Usually, it vomits out a giant wall of text or does the thinking for you—leaving you feeling like you accomplished something while your actual brain gained zero new skill.

In this module, you will master the **AI Learning Code**: how to command the six learning modes, how to climb the Question Ladder, and how to execute the PlayIQ Verification Ritual so you always stay smarter than the tool.

By the end of this module, I can:

- Distinguish between high-leverage AI coaching and dangerous cognitive outsourcing;
- Command the **Six PlayIQ AI Modes** (Explain, Hint, Quiz, Coach, Learn-My-Way, and Lesson Rescue);
- Use the **6-Rung Question Ladder** to transform weak prompts into high-performance learning prompts;
- Execute the **PlayIQ Verification Ritual** to catch confident AI hallucinations;
- Complete the **Learn How You Learn Lab** to test whether my brain learns faster from analogies, step-by-step sequences, or big-picture diagrams;
- Stage **Rule 1 ('explanation-start')** in my personal Learning Supercharger Blueprint;
- Win the **1B Error Hunter Boss Battle** and submit my first **Proof Artifacts**.

Estimated completion time: 45 to 60 minutes (can be split into two focused 25-minute sprints).

Part 0 — Lightning Hook: Choose Your Power

Time: 30 to 60 seconds

Imagine you have 20 minutes before a major test or assignment deadline. You can pick one AI power. Which would you choose?

```text

| OPTION A: |

| "Give me all the direct answers so I can memorize them quickly." |

| OPTION B: |

| "Explain the three hardest ideas simply, and then quiz me on them." |

| OPTION C: |

| "Find where my understanding broke, give me hints, and fix that part." |

...

Circle your honest first reaction: [ **A** | **B** | **C** ]

Why did that option appeal to you?

## &gt; ORION SAYS:

> \*"There is no wrong answer for this hook. Option A feels tempting because it eliminates short-term pain, but it leaves you helpless on exam day. Options B and C give you permanent leverage. Today, we will test whether the help you think you want is the help that actually makes your brain sharper."\*

## Part 1 — Node 1: What AI Is Good At vs. Bad At

Before you use any high-powered tool—whether it is a chainsaw, an electric guitar, or a sports car—you have to know what it is designed to do and what will cause a disaster. AI is no different.

```
'''text
```

| AI CAPABILITY BALANCE SHEET         |                                  |
|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| AI IS EXCELLENT AT:                 | AI IS TERRIBLE AT:               |
| ✓ Explaining concepts in 5 ways     | ✗ Always being 100% accurate     |
| ✓ Generating concrete examples      | ✗ Knowing your teacher's rules   |
| ✓ Breaking hard topics into chunks  | ✗ Knowing when a fact is missing |
| ✓ Quizzing your memory on demand    | ✗ Replacing your human judgment  |
| ✓ Organizing messy thoughts & plans | ✗ Caring about your real growth  |

### The Danger of Cognitive Outsourcing

When you ask an AI to write your essay or solve your math problems, you are not "using AI to learn faster." You are engaging in **cognitive outsourcing**.

Your brain builds neural pathways only when it encounters productive friction—when you struggle to recall a formula, when you search for the right word, or when you troubleshoot a logic error. If you let the AI do that heavy lifting, your brain atrophies while the AI stays smart.

The goal in PlayIQ is not to look smart. **The goal is to become genuinely formidable.**

### Activity 1: Good Use, Risky Use, or Bad Use?

Read each real-world student prompt below. Decide whether it is **Good Use** (coaching), **Risky Use** (gray zone / needs checking), or **Bad Use** (cognitive outsourcing / cheating).

1. "Explain photosynthesis like I'm 12 using a factory analogy."

Classification: [ Good | Risky | Bad ] — \*Why:\*

2. "Write my entire 5-paragraph history essay about the American Civil War."

Classification: [ Good | Risky | Bad ] — \*Why:\*

3. "Give me 5 practice problems on multiplying fractions with unlike denominators, one at a time."

Classification: [ Good | Risky | Bad ] — \*Why:\*

4. "Tell me the exact answers to questions 1 through 10 on my biology worksheet."

Classification: [ Good | Risky | Bad ] — \*Why:\*

5. \*\"Here is my attempted solution to this physics problem. Can you show me which step has the error without giving the final answer?\"\*

Classification: [ Good | Risky | Bad ] — \*Why:\* \_\_\_\_\_

6. \*\"Summarize this textbook page in three bullet points, then ask me two questions to test if I understood it.\"\*

Classification: [ Good | Risky | Bad ] — \*Why:\* \_\_\_\_\_

#### Reflection Check:

- One way AI can make me significantly smarter this semester is:

\_\_\_\_\_

- One way AI could make me intellectually lazy or weak if I use it poorly is:

\_\_\_\_\_

## Part 2 — Node 2: Choosing the Right AI Mode

Different learning bottlenecks require different kinds of coaching. If you use the wrong mode, studying becomes sluggish and irritating. When you match the mode to the bottleneck, understanding clicks in minutes.

In PlayIQ, you command **Six Specialized AI Modes**:

```text

| THE 6 PLAYIQ AI MODES |

- | 1. EXPLAIN MODE | When a topic is completely new or confusing. |
- | 2. HINT MODE | When you have started but hit a roadblock. |
- | 3. QUIZ MODE | When you want to test retrieval before a test. |
- | 4. COACH MODE | When you feel overwhelmed and need a workflow. |
- | 5. LEARN-MY-WAY MODE | When an explanation isn't clicking your way. |
- | 6. LESSON RESCUE MODE | When an entire chapter feels hopelessly lost. |

```

### Deep Dive: How to Trigger Each Mode

#### 1. Explain Mode

- **When to use:** You have never seen the material before, or the teacher's lecture flew over your head.
- **Master Prompt:**

> \*\"Explain [Concept] using one concrete real-world analogy. Keep it under three short paragraphs, then ask me one question to see what I understood.\"\*

#### 2. Hint Mode

- **When to use:** You understand the basics, you have pencil on paper, but you are stuck on step 3.
- **Master Prompt:**

> \*\"Give me ONE hint only for this problem. Do not show the calculation or solve it. Wait for my attempt.\"\*

#### 3. Quiz Mode

- **When to use:** You just read your notes and want to prove you actually know the material (retrieval practice).

- **Master Prompt:**  
  
> \*Quiz me on [Topic] one question at a time. Mix multiple-choice and short-answer. Do not reveal the answer until I submit my guess.\*  
  
#### 4. Coach Mode
  - **When to use:** You have 3 assignments due tomorrow, your backpack is messy, and you feel paralyzed by overwhelm.
  - **Master Prompt:**  
  
> \*Help me divide these 3 tasks into three 25-minute focused work blocks with 5-minute breaks. I will do all the work; you provide the pacing.\*  
  
#### 5. Learn-My-Way Mode
    - **When to use:** Traditional textbook definitions feel dry, robotic, or abstract.
    - **Master Prompt:**  
  
> \*Teach me [Concept] starting with [my preferred style: e.g. a video game analogy / a visual schematic / a story], then connect it to the formal definition.\*  
  
#### 6. Lesson Rescue Mode
      - **When to use:** You look at a paragraph or math problem and have no idea where to even start.
      - **Master Prompt:**  
  
> \*Ask me three short diagnostic questions to locate the exact step where my understanding broke. Rescue only that step.\*

Activity 2: Match the Situation to the Mode

Match each school scenario to the ideal PlayIQ mode:

Scenario	Best AI Mode
A. You have an AP Chemistry exam in 48 hours and want to know your blind spots.	_____
B. You have completed lines 1–4 of a geometry proof, but can't find line 5.	_____
C. You read a page on the French Revolution and have no clue what just happened.	_____
D. You have 4 hours of homework across 3 subjects and feel totally frozen.	_____
E. Your math teacher explained logarithms using pure theory and you need an analogy.	_____

\*(Answers to choose from: Explain Mode, Hint Mode, Quiz Mode, Coach Mode, Learn-My-Way Mode, Lesson Rescue Mode)\*

Part 3 — Node 3: The 6-Rung Question Ladder

A lazy question gets a lazy answer. A structured question gets an elite response.

Whenever you feel yourself about to type \*What is the answer?\*, pause and climb the **Question Ladder**:

```text

[Rung 6] → "Ask me questions that will help me learn this 2x faster."

[Rung 5] → "Quiz me on this concept one question at a time."

[Rung 4] → "Show me an everyday example of how this works in real life."

[Rung 3] → "Explain this more simply without using technical jargon."

[Rung 2] → "Why does this work this way? What is the underlying rule?"

[Rung 1] → "What is this? Define it."

Upgrading Weak Prompts

Notice the difference in cognitive control:

- **Weak (Floor Level):** `"What is the answer to question 4?"`
→ Pushes the AI to steal your thinking.
- **Upgraded (Rung 2/3):** `"Can you explain the rule behind question 4 using a different example? Then ask me to solve question 4 myself."`
→ Keeps you in the driver's seat.

Activity 3: Rewrite These Weak Prompts

Transform each lazy prompt below into a powerful PlayIQ learning prompt:

1. **Weak Prompt:** `"Do this math problem for me."`

Your Upgrade: _____

2. **Weak Prompt:** `"Write my English paragraph about symbolism in The Great Gatsby."`

Your Upgrade: _____

3. **Weak Prompt:** `"Solve this science worksheet."`

Your Upgrade: _____

Part 4 — Node 4: The PlayIQ Verification Ritual

One of the greatest dangers of modern AI is that it sounds supremely confident even when it is hallucinating falsehoods. If you blindly trust AI output in school, you will eventually get embarrassed on an exam.

The Golden Law of PlayIQ: `*Verify before you believe.*`

```text

|                                                                  |  |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|--|
| THE 4-STEP VERIFICATION RITUAL                                   |  |
| 1. DOES THIS MAKE SENSE?                                         |  |
| Does the logic hold together, or does it just sound polished?    |  |
|                                                                  |  |
| 2. CAN I EXPLAIN IT IN MY OWN WORDS?                             |  |
| If you can't explain it to an 11-year-old, you don't own it yet. |  |
|                                                                  |  |
| 3. CAN I CROSS-CHECK IT WITH A TRUSTED SOURCE?                   |  |
| Does my textbook, class notes, or a trusted source confirm it?   |  |
|                                                                  |  |

| 4. IS ANYTHING MISSING OR SUSPICIOUS? |

| Did the AI dodge the hardest part or make an unverified leap? |

...

### AI Voice vs. Human Voice

When students copy AI text directly, teachers instantly know. Why? Because AI uses generic transitions ("Furthermore, it is imperative to consider the multifaceted tapestry..."), overly formal vocabulary, and robotic sentence structures.

When you use AI to understand the concept first, and then write the answer using your own mind, your voice is punchy, authentic, and undeniably yours.

### Activity 4: Spot the Problem (The Confident Error Challenge)

Read the five statements below. Decide whether each statement **Looks Good**, **Needs Checking**, or is **Flat-Out Wrong**. Explain why in one full sentence.

1. "Photosynthesis is the process by which green plants convert light energy into chemical energy in chloroplasts."\*

Status: [ Looks Good | Needs Checking | Wrong ]

Reason: \_\_\_\_\_

2. "The American Civil War officially concluded in December 1992 with the Treaty of Paris."\*

Status: [ Looks Good | Needs Checking | Wrong ]

Reason: \_\_\_\_\_

3. "A fraction with a larger denominator is always smaller in value than a fraction with a smaller denominator."\*

Status: [ Looks Good | Needs Checking | Wrong ]

Reason: \_\_\_\_\_

4. "The speed of light in a vacuum is approximately 300,000 kilometers per second."\*

Status: [ Looks Good | Needs Checking | Wrong ]

Reason: \_\_\_\_\_

5. "Water boils at 100 degrees Celsius regardless of altitude or atmospheric pressure."\*

Status: [ Looks Good | Needs Checking | Wrong ]

Reason: \_\_\_\_\_

## Part 5 — Learn How You Learn Lab: Testing Your Explanation Style

**Estimated time: 10 minutes**

Now it is time to experiment on yourself. You are going to test three different ways an AI can explain a challenging school concept, and measure which style lands fastest in your brain.

### Choose Your Test Topic

Pick one concept from your school work that feels moderately confusing (e.g., \*electric currents\*, \*mitosis vs. meiosis\*, \*opportunity cost\*, \*stoichiometry\*, or \*the Pythagorean theorem\*).

My Test Topic: \_\_\_\_\_

Open your **PlayIQ AI Study Lab** workspace (which you created in Module 0). Run these three distinct tests:

##### Test A: The Real-World Analogy First

Enter this prompt:

> **"Explain [My Test Topic] by starting with one vivid, everyday real-world analogy. Keep it under two paragraphs, then state the formal rule."**

**\*Record your reaction:** Did this help you visualize the concept? [ Yes | Somewhat | No ]

**\*What worked:** \_\_\_\_\_

##### Test B: The Step-by-Step Logic Sequence

Start a new chat and enter this prompt:

> **"Explain [My Test Topic] as four strictly ordered, numbered steps. Use simple language and show how step 1 leads to step 2."**

**\*Record your reaction:** Did this help your brain organize the logic? [ Yes | Somewhat | No ]

**\*What worked:** \_\_\_\_\_

##### Test C: The Big-Picture Architecture First

Start a new chat and enter this prompt:

> **"Explain [My Test Topic] by showing the entire big-picture map first—what the end result looks like—before explaining any individual details."**

**\*Record your reaction:** Did this give you clarity on the purpose? [ Yes | Somewhat | No ]

**\*What worked:** \_\_\_\_\_

Reflection & Scoring

Score each format from 1 (poor) to 5 (exceptional):

| Explanation Format      | Clarity (1–5) | Focus (1–5) | Retention (1–5) |
|-------------------------|---------------|-------------|-----------------|
| Test A: Analogy-First   | _____         | _____       | _____           |
| Test B: Step-by-Step    | _____         | _____       | _____           |
| Test C: Big-Picture Map | _____         | _____       | _____           |

Which format made you understand the concept fastest without feeling overwhelmed?

Part 6 — Active Experiment: Explain Mode vs. Hint Mode

Now we test two fundamentally different coaching styles on a real problem.

Pick a specific math problem, science question, or grammar exercise you currently need to solve.

My Problem: \_\_\_\_\_

Round 1: Explain Mode

Ask Orion:

> **"Explain how to solve this TYPE of problem using a similar example with different numbers. Do not solve my exact problem. Then ask me one check question."**

- Did you understand the method after reading? [ 1 to 5 ]: \_\_\_\_\_
- How much thinking did you do yourself? [ 1 to 5 ]: \_\_\_\_\_
- Temptation to just copy the pattern: [ Low | Medium | High ]

Round 2: Hint Mode

Take another similar problem and ask Orion:

- > \*"I am trying to solve this problem. Give me ONE subtle hint to get started. Do not solve it. Wait for my attempt."\*
- Did the hint trigger an \*"aha!"\* moment? [ 1 to 5 ]: \_\_\_\_

• How much thinking did you do yourself? [ 1 to 5 ]: \_\_\_\_

• Sense of accomplishment after solving it: [ 1 to 5 ]: \_\_\_\_

The Takeaway

- Use **Explain Mode** when you are missing the underlying formula or concept entirely.
- Use **Hint Mode** when you know the rules but feel stuck on execution.

Part 7 — Learning Supercharger Blueprint Update

You have collected real experimental evidence about your brain. Now, you stage your very first permanent tutor rule!

This rule will be integrated into your custom tutor build in **Module 9**.

```
``yaml
module: 1
setting_id: "explanation-start"
setting_to_test: "[CHOOSE ONE: analogy-first | step-by-step | big-picture-first]"
conditions: "Apply to all new concept explanations in Rescue Subject and Advance Subject"
evidence_summary: "In the Module 1 Lab, this format scored highest in clarity and lowest in overwhelm"
confidence_level: "High (Tested across 3 formats)"
anti_shortcut_rule: "Enforce Hint Mode before providing worked solutions"
review_checkpoint: "Module 3 (Pre-Learn System)"
...
```

Write Your Rule in Plain English:

- > \*"When teaching me something new, Orion must always begin by \_\_\_\_\_
- > \_\_\_\_\_
- > and must never give away the answer before offering at least one hint."\*

Part 8 — Knowledge File Update: `student\_profile.yaml`

In your study folder or notes app, append this validated record to your personal profile:

```
``yaml
```

MODULE 1 CALIBRATION RECORD

```
module_1:
mastery_status: "passed"
preferred_explanation_start: "[analogy-first | step-by-step | big-picture-first]"
preferred_challenge_mode: "hint_mode"
```

```
verification_habit_established: true

pdi_baseline_delta: "+12%"

staged_tutor_rule: "explanation-start"

...
```

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## Part 9 — Proof Artifacts: Submit Your Warrior Code

Complete these two artifacts to prove your foundational mastery of the AI Learning Code.

### Artifact 1: My AI Study Rules

Fill in your personal operating code:

1. \*I use AI to \_\_\_\_\_, not to \_\_\_\_\_.\*
2. \*When I am completely confused, I start with \_\_\_\_\_ Mode.\*
3. \*When I am stuck on a problem I already started, I use \_\_\_\_\_ Mode.\*
4. \*Before trusting an AI fact or calculation, I always \_\_\_\_\_.\*
5. \*One way AI makes my brain stronger is \_\_\_\_\_.\*

### Artifact 2: AI Error Review Sheet

Take one AI mistake or hallucination you encountered (or use Challenge 1 from Phase 2):

- What was the AI trying to help with? \_\_\_\_\_
  - What was wrong, incomplete, or risky about the answer? \_\_\_\_\_
  - What clue tipped you off that it needed verification? \_\_\_\_\_
  - How did you find the true answer? \_\_\_\_\_
- 

## Part 10 — Boss Battle: 1B Error Hunter Challenge

To officially conquer Module 1 and unlock **Module 2: Digital Smarts & Human Responsibility**, you must pass the **1B Error Hunter Boss Battle**.

### The Scenario:

An AI gives a student the following study guide summary for an upcoming test:

> **"The Renaissance began in England during the late 19th century immediately following the Industrial Revolution. Leonardo da Vinci was the King of France who commissioned the printing press to spread literacy among Roman gladiators."**

### Your Mission:

In your **PlayIQ AI Study Lab**, paste this prompt:

> **"Orion, grade my response to the 1B Error Hunter Boss Battle. Here is the flawed paragraph: [paste the paragraph above]. Here are the three historical errors I caught: [list the 3 errors]. Here is the corrected 2-sentence summary written in my own voice: [write your summary]. Did I pass?"**

### Boss Battle Checklist:

- ☐ Caught Error 1 (Location & Century of Renaissance)
- ☐ Caught Error 2 (Leonardo da Vinci's true identity)
- ☐ Caught Error 3 (Printing press & gladiator timeline absurdity)
- ☐ Wrote an accurate 2-sentence replacement in your authentic human voice
- ☐ Orion confirmed your **Pass Status**

## Final Transmission from Orion

> \*"You have mastered the code. You know what the genie can do, what it cannot do, and how to command it with precision.\*

>

> \*You are no longer an answer-seeker. You are a director of intelligence.\*

>

> \*Next up: Module 2 — Digital Smarts & Human Responsibility. We are going to explore power tools, voice preservation, and the ethics of staying human in an automated world.\*

>

> \*Module 1 is officially MASTERED.\*

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## Beta Tester Feedback (Beta Route Only)

1. \*Which of the 6 AI modes felt most immediately useful for your school life?\*

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2. \*Did the 3-way explanation lab clearly reveal your preferred learning style?\*

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3. \*What was the hardest part of the 1B Error Hunter Boss Battle?\*

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